Finance, Administration and Economic Development Committee Meeting

Beaufort County, SC

Council Chambers, Administration Building
Beaufort County Government Robert Smalls Complex
100 Ribaut Road, Beaufort

Monday, May 18, 2026
2:00 PM

MINUTES

Watch the video stream available on the County's website to hear the Council's discussion of a specific topic or the complete meeting **https://beaufortcountysc.new.swagit.com/videos/388328**

1. Call to Order

Committee Chair Lawson called the meeting to order at 2:00 PM

Present
Committee Chair Mark Lawson
Committee Vice-Chair Logan Cunningham - Virtual @ 2:10 PM
Committee Member Gerald Dawson - Virtual
Ex-Officio Alice Howard
Committee Member Joseph Passiment
Committee Member Paula Brown
Vice-Chair Anna Maria Tabernik
Council Member York Glover
Council Member Lawrence McElynn - Virtual

Absent
Council Member David Bartholomew
Council Member Thomas Reitz

2. Pledge of Allegiance

Committee Chair Lawson led the Pledge of Allegiance.

3. Statement of Compliance with FOIA

Committee Chair Lawson stated that public notification of this meeting had been published, posted, and distributed in compliance with SC FOIA.

4. Approval of Agenda

Motion: It was moved by Committee Member Passiment, seconded by Council Member Glover to approve the agenda.

Motion to Amend: It was moved by Vice-Chair Tabernik, seconded by Committee Member Brown to amend the agenda to move item 8.a. to before public comment.

The Vote - Voting Yea: Committee Chair Lawson, Committee Member Dawson, Ex-Officio Howard, Committee Member Passiment, Committee Member Brown, Vice-Chair Tabernik, Council Member Glover, and Council Member McElynn. The motion to amend passed 8:0.

Main Motion: It was moved by Committee Member Passiment, seconded by Ex-Officio Howard to approve the agenda as amended.

The Vote - Voting Yea: Committee Chair Lawson, Committee Member Dawson, Ex-Officio Howard, Committee Member Passiment, Committee Member Brown, Vice-Chair Tabernik, Council Member Glover, and Council Member McElynn. The amended motion passed 8:0.

5. Approval of Minutes

Motion: It was moved by Committee Member Passiment, seconded by Vice-Chair Tabernik to approve the minutes from April 20, 2026.

The Vote - Voting Yea: Committee Chair Lawson, Committee Member Dawson, Ex-Officio Howard, Committee Member Passiment, Committee Member Brown, Vice-Chair Tabernik, Council Member Glover, and Council Member McElynn. The motion passed 8:0.

6. Presentation/Discussion Items

a. Consideration of Port Royal Business Park **(FISCAL IMPACT: Town requests $10,000,000 in funding approval payable in increments of not exceeding $1mm for a period lasting until the earlier of (i) 20 years, or (ii) full funding of the $10,000,000. Based on proportional millage, this represents 55.25% School District ($5.525mm), 20.25% County ($2.025mm), and 24.5% Town ($2.45mm).)** - Lawrence Flynn, Pope Flynn, LLC – Bond Counsel to Town, Van Willis, Town Manager & Kevin Phillips, Mayor

Kevin Phillips, Mayor of Port Royal, and Lawrence Flynn, Pope Flynn, LLC presented a PowerPoint of the Port Royal Business Park for consideration. Please watch the video stream on the county's website to view the full presentation. **https://beaufortcountysc.new.swagit.com/videos/388328**

7. Public Comment Period

Public comments were taken. Please watch the video stream on the county's website to view the full comment period. **https://beaufortcountysc.new.swagit.com/videos/388328**

8. Reports

a. FY2026 YTD Budget Report and Budget Transfer Report - Sandra Novak, Finance Director

Sandra Novak, Finance Director, presented a PowerPoint on the FY2026 YTD Budget Report. Please watch the video stream on the county's website to view the full report. **https://beaufortcountysc.new.swagit.com/videos/388328**

9. Agenda Items

a. FY2026-2027 Budget Presentation **(FISCAL IMPACT: $203,338,263 appropriated to the Beaufort County General Fund to fund County operations.)** - Michael Moore, Beaufort County Administrator

Michael Moore, County Administrator, presented a PowerPoint of the FY2027 Budget Overview. Please watch the video stream on the county's website to view the full presentation. **https://beaufortcountysc.new.swagit.com/videos/388328**

b. An Ordinance to make appropriations for County Government and Special Purpose Districts for Beaufort County for the fiscal year beginning July 1, 2026, and ending June 30, 2027; to levy taxes for the payment thereof; to adopt service and user fees; to provide for the expenditure of said taxes and other revenues coming into the county; and other matters related thereto **(FISCAL IMPACT: The Ordinance will outline the revenues to be collected and estimated expenditures for the Fiscal Year 2026 - 2027.)** - Michael Moore, Beaufort County Administrator

Motion: It was moved by Committee Member Passiment, seconded by Council Member Glover to approve an Ordinance to make appropriations for County Government and Special Purpose Districts for Beaufort County for the fiscal year beginning July 1,2026, and ending June 30, 2027; to levy taxes for the payment thereof; to adopt service and user fees; to provide for the expenditure of said taxes and other revenues coming into the county; and other matters related thereto.

The Vote - Voting Yea: Committee Chair Lawson, Committee Member Dawson, Ex-Officio Howard, Committee Member Passiment, Committee Member Brown, Council Member Glover, and Council Member McElynn.

Voting Nay: Vice-Chair Tabernik. The motion passed 7:1.

c. An Ordinance to provide for the levy of tax for school purposes for Beaufort County for the fiscal year beginning July 1, 2026, and ending June 30, 2027, and to make appropriations for said purposes

(FISCAL IMPACT:) - Dr. Frank Rodriguez, BCSD Superintendent; & Tonya Crosby, CPA, BCSD Chief Financial Officer

Motion: It was moved by Committee Member Passiment, seconded by Council Member Glover to approve an Ordinance to provide for the levy of tax for school purposes for Beaufort County for the fiscal year beginning July 1, 2026, and ending June 30, 2027, and to make appropriations for said purposes.

The Vote - Voting Yea: Committee Chair Lawson, Committee Member Dawson, Ex-Officio Howard, Committee Member Passiment, Committee Member Brown, Vice-Chair Tabernik, Council Member Glover, and Council Member McElynn. The motion passed 8:0.

d. An Ordinance to appropriate and issue a refund of impact fees paid for the Garden Oaks Apartments affordable housing development **(FISCAL IMPACT: $176,961.16)** - Emily Zackon, Attorney for GDA Development Partners

Motion: It was moved by Ex-Officio Howard, seconded by Committee Member Passiment to approve an Ordinance to appropriate and issue a refund of impact fees paid for the Garden Oaks Apartments affordable housing development.

The Vote - Voting Yea: Committee Member Dawson, Ex-Officio Howard, Committee Member Passiment, Council Member Glover, and Council Member McElynn.

Voting Nay: Committee Chair Lawson, Committee Member Brown, and Vice-Chair Tabernik. The motion passed 5:3.

e. A Resolution to Award FY26 Local 3% Accommodations Tax Grants **(FISCAL IMPACT: Fund 2001 has a Fund Balance of $8,978,182.06 and actual revenues of $1,791,550.47 as of May 13, 2026. $2,000,000 has been allocated for the FY2026 grant cycle.)** - Allison Kirby, Grants Administrator (20 minutes)

Motion: It was moved by Vice-Chair Tabernik, seconded by Ex-Officio Howard to move the item to the next Finance Committee Meeting.

The Vote - Voting Yea: Committee Chair Lawson, Committee Member Dawson, Ex-Officio Howard, Committee Member Passiment, Committee Member Brown, Vice-Chair Tabernik, Council Member Glover, and Council Member McElynn. The motion passed 8:0.

f. Award of two contracts to Dominion Energy for Electric Vehicle Chargers at two Beaufort County locations: Buckwalter Recreation Park and Admin Building. **(FISCAL IMPACT: $80,000.00)** - Frank Stroncheck. Facilities Director & Allison Kirby, Grants Administrator

Motion: It was moved by Committee Member Passiment, seconded by Vice-Chair Tabernik to approve an award of two contracts to Dominion Energy for Electric Vehicle Chargers at two Beaufort County locations: Buckwalter Recreation Park and Admin Building.

Motion: It was moved by Vice-Chair Tabernik, seconded by Committee Member Passiment to direct staff to come back to Council with a Resolution setting the fees for any charge.

The Vote - Voting Yea: Committee Chair Lawson, Committee Member Dawson, Ex-Officio Howard, Committee Member Passiment, Committee Member Brown, Vice-Chair Tabernik, Council Member Glover, and Council Member McElynn. The motion passed 8:0.

10. Adjournment

Ratified: June 15, 2026